MATH INQUIRERS HOLIDAY PROGRAM

Lesson 6 Trial: Coin Combos

A 60-minute trial lesson plan with the pupil sheet

Notice it. Test it. Explain why.

TRIAL LESSON • 60 MINUTES • LEVEL 1

Math Inquirers Holiday Program

Lesson 6: Coin Combos

Notice it. Test it. Explain why.

A shortened version of Lesson 6 for one classroom period, designed for a class of 29. It has a timed plan with a script, a two-page worksheet, exit tickets, a coin cut-out page and a one-page observation sheet so that you can record what happened.

At a glance

Big idea	Find every way to make an amount with coins, and be sure you have found them all, by starting with the biggest coin and working down.
Objective	Pupils make 20¢ and 30¢ in different ways with 20¢, 10¢ and 5¢ coins, record the ways in a table, find the fewest coins for an amount, and explain how they know they have every way.
Class set-up	14 pairs and 1 group of three. One coin sheet and one mini whiteboard (or scrap paper) per pair. Each pupil has a worksheet and a pencil.
Materials	15 sheets of the coin cut-outs (one per pair, already cut and in an envelope), 29 worksheets (2 pages, double-sided), 29 exit tickets, 15 mini whiteboards or scrap paper, a board or visualiser for the demonstration.
Prepare	Solve the worksheet yourself. Cut the coins ahead of time (you can use real 5¢, 10¢ and 20¢ coins instead). Put one envelope on every pair's desk before pupils arrive.
Before you use it	Check with your school leaders before using outside material with a class. Do not put pupil names on the observation sheet or take photos of pupils. Record only counts and what you observed.

The 60 minutes

Minutes	Part	What happens
0–5	**Warm-up**	Money shop: pay for six items with play coins and notes, fewest pieces

5–15	**Explore**	In pairs, make 20¢ in as many ways as they can
15–23	**Mini-lesson**	Worked examples and the key idea
23–25	**Brain break**	Coin toss count, standing up
25–45	**Worksheet**	Pairs first, then on their own, then stretch
45–53	**Talk time**	Share and explain why
53–60	**Exit ticket**	One question on a slip, collect, one-sentence reflection

Running it with 29 pupils

- Seat pupils in pairs before the lesson and put the envelope on the desk. Decide who is the trio.
- Use signals: “Pencils down” for attention, and “Show me” for pairs to hold up their whiteboard so that you can scan the room in ten seconds.
- Split the room into three zones and visit each zone in turn while pairs work, so that every pair is asked at least one question.
- When a pair is stuck, give hint 1 and move on. Come back in two minutes. Do not rescue a pair too quickly.
- For pupils who find the work hard, start the table with the ways that use no 20¢ coin. For fast finishers, give the stretch question, then the challenge.
- Count out loud from the back of the room: “Ten seconds to finish” and “Five seconds”, so that pupils can plan their finish.

Script

0–5 min Warm-up: Money shop

DO Pupils already have play coins (5¢, 10¢, 20¢, 50¢, $1) and play notes ($2, $5, $10, $50) on the desk. Point to one item on the Money Shop slide at a time. Pairs lay out the money, then you click to show the fewest way.

SAY *“Welcome to the money shop! Look at the price tag. Is it cents or dollars? Pay exactly with your coins and notes. Can you use fewer pieces than your partner?”*

Ask	Expect
Eraser 65¢.	50¢ + 10¢ + 5¢ (3 coins)
Pencil 80¢.	50¢ + 20¢ + 10¢ (3 coins)
Sticker book $3.	$2 note + $1 coin
Water bottle $12.	$10 + $2 (2 notes)
Toy car $25.	$10 + $10 + $5 (3 notes)

Scooter $65.	$50 + $10 + $5 (3 notes)

5–15 min Explore: how many ways make 20¢?

SAY *"Today we are going to find every way to make 20¢ using only 20¢, 10¢ and 5¢ coins. First, a prediction. How many different ways do you think there are? Write your guess on your whiteboard."*

"Make 20¢ with your coins. Then change some coins to make 20¢ a different way. Draw or write each way. Keep going. Talk to your partner. I will come and ask questions."

DO Ask pairs to write each way on the whiteboard, like "10 + 5 + 5".

At about minute 13, say "Pencils down" and ask the three questions below.

Ask	Expect
How many ways did you find for 20¢?	4 ways: 20; 10 + 10; 10 + 5 + 5; 5 + 5 + 5 + 5.
How do you know you have all of them?	Start with the biggest coin and work down.
Are 10 + 5 + 5 and 5 + 10 + 5 different ways?	No. The same coins in a different order is the same way.

IF STUCK Hint 1: "Start with the biggest coin that fits." Hint 2: "Keep one coin the same and change the others." Hint 3: "Make 10¢ first, then 10¢ again."

15–23 min Mini-lesson

DO Draw the table on the board as you think aloud. Columns: 20¢, 10¢, 5¢.

SAY *"Ways to make 15¢ with 10¢ and 5¢ coins. I start with the biggest coin: one 10¢. Then 5¢ is left, so one 5¢ coin. That is one way: 10 + 5."*

"Now no 10¢ coin. Only 5¢ coins: 5 + 5 + 5. That makes two ways altogether."

"Now 25¢ with 20¢, 10¢ and 5¢. With one 20¢: 20 + 5. With 10¢ but no 20¢: 10 + 10 + 5, and 10 + 5 + 5 + 5. With only 5¢ coins: 5 + 5 + 5 + 5 + 5. That makes 4 ways, and the table helped me to not miss any or repeat any."

"The key idea today: start with the biggest coin and work down. Same coins in a different order count as one way. Say it with me."

Ask	Expect
How many ways make 15¢ using 10¢ and 5¢?	2 ways: 10 + 5; 5 + 5 + 5.
How many ways make 25¢ using 20¢, 10¢ and 5¢?	4 ways.

Watch for: writing the same way twice in a different order; missing the "no 20¢, no 10¢" row; forgetting that the coins must add up exactly.

23–25 min Brain break: coin toss count

DO Pupils stand. Toss a pretend coin: heads, 5 star jumps. Tails, 10 knee lifts. Do three tosses and count the total together. Then sit down and take out the worksheet.

25–45 min Worksheet (20 minutes)

DO Minutes 25 to 33: pairs do Question 1 together (the 30¢ table).

Minutes 33 to 41: each pupil does Questions 2 and 3 alone.

Minutes 41 to 45: stretch question for pupils who have finished. Others finish Question 3.

SAY *"Pairs first on Question 1. Talk about each way before you write it. I am not looking for speed. I am looking for good thinking. Check each way adds up to 30¢."*

DO Circulate and ask:

- "Which coin did you start with in this way?"
- "Is this way the same as that one? Show me with coins."
- "How do you know there are no more ways?"

IF STUCK Hint 1: "Begin with the biggest coin." Hint 2: "Keep one coin fixed and change the others." Hint 3: "Add up your coins. Is it exactly 30¢?"

Worksheet answers

Question	Answer
Q1. Ways to make 30¢ with 20¢, 10¢ and 5¢	6 ways: 20 + 10; 20 + 5 + 5; 10 + 10 + 10; 10 + 10 + 5 + 5; 10 + 5 + 5 + 5 + 5; 5 × 6. (a) fewest: 20 + 10 (2 coins). (b) most: 5 × 6 (6 coins). (c) Start with the biggest coin and work down.
Q2. Mei pays 45¢. Fewest coins from 5¢, 10¢, 20¢, 50¢?	3 coins: 20¢ + 20¢ + 5¢.
Q3. Ben has 3 coins worth 35¢. Which coins? Can he use only 2?	20¢ + 10¢ + 5¢. No: two coins can make 10, 15, 20, 25, 30, 40, 55, 60, 70 or 100, and 35 is not one of them.
Stretch. Ali pays 55¢ with exactly 5 coins, using at least one 5¢, one 10¢ and one 20¢.	20¢ + 10¢ + 10¢ + 10¢ + 5¢ (the only way).

45–53 min Talk time

DO Bring pupils to attention. Pick two or three pairs, not only the fastest. Ask for the reason, not only the answer.

SAY *"Who found a way to make 30¢ that nobody else found? Tell us."*

"How did you make sure you found every way?"

"Is 10 + 5 + 5 different from 5 + 10 + 5?"

"Why can 35¢ never be made with only two coins?"

Ask	Listen for

How did you make sure you found every way?	Start with the biggest coin and work down, using a table.
Is 10 + 5 + 5 different from 5 + 10 + 5?	No. They use the same coins, so they are one way.
Why can 35¢ never be made with two coins?	Listen for: try every pair of coins and none of them add to 35.

53–60 min Exit ticket and closing

DO Hand out the exit ticket slips. No talking, no helping. Give about 4 minutes. Collect the slips, then collect the worksheets and coin envelopes.

Exit ticket	Answer
Make 25¢ using exactly three coins from 5¢, 10¢, 20¢, 50¢.	10¢ + 10¢ + 5¢.

SAY *"You found every way and you could explain how you knew. That is what an inquirer does: notice, test, check and explain why."*

"Thumbs up, sideways or down: how hard was today? Tell your partner one thing you liked."

After the lesson: what to record

Fill this in within an hour of the lesson, while you still remember. Please do not write pupil names. This sheet is what will tell us how to improve the program.

Timing

Part	Planned	Actual	Notes: too long, too short, rushed?
Warm-up	5		
Explore	10		
Mini-lesson	8		
Brain break	2		
Worksheet	20		
Talk time	8		
Exit ticket	7		

How the pupils did

Measure	Count
Pairs that found all 4 ways for 20¢ in Explore (out of 15)	
Pairs that used “biggest coin first” without being told	
Pairs that found all 6 ways for 30¢ (out of 15)	
Pupils who got Question 2 right (45¢ in 3 coins) (out of 29)	
Pupils who got the exit ticket right (out of 29)	
Pupils who could say why in their own words (your estimate)	

What to change

Which question or step confused most pupils?

Which part of the script did you change, and why?

Which materials did not work (coins, worksheet layout, whiteboards)?

Pupil voice (ask a few pupils in the last minute)

- What was the best part?
- What was the hardest part?
- Would you like to do more lessons like this? Why or why not?

MATH INQUIRERS HOLIDAY PROGRAM • LEVEL 1

MONEY

Name: _____ **Class:** _____ **Date:** _____

COIN COMBOS

We have 5¢, 10¢, 20¢ and 50¢ coins. You can use the same kind of coin more than once.

1. Show different ways to make exactly 30¢ using only 20¢, 10¢ and 5¢ coins. Write how many of each coin in the table. Use your coins to test each way.

Way	Number of 20¢	Number of 10¢	Number of 5¢
A			
B			
C			
D			
E			
F			

(a) Which way uses the FEWEST coins?

Answer: _____

(b) Which way uses the MOST coins?

Answer: _____

(c) How do you know you have found ALL the ways?

2. Mei wants to pay exactly 45¢. She can use 5¢, 10¢, 20¢ and 50¢ coins. What is the smallest number of coins she can use? Which coins are they?

Answer: _____

3. Ben has 3 coins. They are worth 35¢ altogether. Which coins does he have?

Answer: _____

(a) Can Ben make 35¢ using only 2 coins? Explain your answer.

Think harder

4. Ali pays 55¢ with exactly 5 coins. He uses at least one 5¢, one 10¢ and one 20¢ coin. Which coins does he use?

Answer: _____

One thing I noticed today: _____

Exit tickets

Print one page for 8 pupils (4 rows of two slips) and cut along the lines. You need 29 slips, so print four pages.

Exit ticket • Lesson 6 Make 25¢ using exactly three coins from 5¢, 10¢, 20¢, 50¢. My answer: _____ How do I know? _____	**Exit ticket • Lesson 6** Make 25¢ using exactly three coins from 5¢, 10¢, 20¢, 50¢. My answer: _____ How do I know? _____
Exit ticket • Lesson 6 Make 25¢ using exactly three coins from 5¢, 10¢, 20¢, 50¢. My answer: _____ How do I know? _____	**Exit ticket • Lesson 6** Make 25¢ using exactly three coins from 5¢, 10¢, 20¢, 50¢. My answer: _____ How do I know? _____
Exit ticket • Lesson 6 Make 25¢ using exactly three coins from 5¢, 10¢, 20¢, 50¢. My answer: _____ How do I know? _____	**Exit ticket • Lesson 6** Make 25¢ using exactly three coins from 5¢, 10¢, 20¢, 50¢. My answer: _____ How do I know? _____
Exit ticket • Lesson 6 Make 25¢ using exactly three coins from 5¢, 10¢, 20¢, 50¢. My answer: _____ How do I know? _____	**Exit ticket • Lesson 6** Make 25¢ using exactly three coins from 5¢, 10¢, 20¢, 50¢. My answer: _____ How do I know? _____

Coin cut-outs

Print 15 copies of this page, one for each pair. Cut along the circles and put the coins in an envelope. Each sheet has 7 × 5¢, 7 × 10¢, 6 × 20¢ and 5 × 50¢. You can also use real or play coins instead.

